

MATERIAL

1. Passage anchor

> “...even a small business needs the right tools, ****materials****, and a bit of breathing room at the beginning.”

Passage meaning

****material**** = physical substances or supplies used to make, produce, or prepare something
****材料；物料****

Here, the speaker means practical supplies needed for the dessert business.

Practice

1. I would need to buy good-quality ****materials****.
我需要購買品質良好的****材料****。
2. The business needs the right ****materials**** for baking and packaging.
這門生意需要合適的烘焙和包裝****物料****。

Core meanings of MATERIAL

2. material — physical substance

= substance from which something is made
****材料；物料****

Examples

1. Wood is a common building ****material****.
木材是一種常見的建築****材料****。
2. The product is made from recycled ****materials****.
這項產品由回收****物料****製成。

This is the exact passage branch.

3. raw material

= basic substance used to manufacture or produce something

****原料****

Examples

1. Flour is a basic raw ****material**** in food production.

麵粉是食品生產中的基本****原料****。

2. The factory imports most of its raw ****materials****.

工廠大部分****原料****依賴進口。

Fabric / textile

4. material — cloth / fabric

= cloth used for making clothes, curtains, furniture coverings, etc.

****布料；衣料****

Examples

1. This dress is made from a soft ****material****.

這條裙是用柔軟的****布料****製成。

2. We need more ****material**** for the curtains.

我們需要更多****布料****做窗簾。

Major everyday sense.

5. waterproof / synthetic material

= fabric or substance with a particular physical property

****防水 / 合成材料****

Examples

1. The jacket is made from waterproof ****material****.

這件外套由****防水物料****製成。

2. Some bags use synthetic ****materials****.

有些袋使用****合成材料****。

Information / content

6. material — information or content

= information, ideas, facts, images, recordings, etc. used for a particular purpose

****資料；內容；素材****

Examples

1. The documentary contains a lot of historical ****material****.

這部紀錄片包含很多歷史****資料****。

2. She collected enough ****material**** for the article.

她收集了足夠的文章****素材****。

Major abstract sense.

7. source material

= original information or content used to create another work

****原始素材；資料來源****

Examples

1. The novel provided the ****source material**** for the film.

這本小說提供了電影的****原始素材****。

2. Researchers checked the ****source material**** carefully.

研究人員仔細核對****原始資料****。

Teaching / study

8. teaching / learning material

= books, worksheets, videos, exercises, etc. used for education

****教材；學習材料****

Examples

1. The teacher prepared new ****teaching materials****.

老師準備了新的****教材****。

2. The course includes online **learning materials**.

這門課包含線上**學習材料**。

9. reading material

= texts available or intended for reading

閱讀材料；讀物

Examples

1. I brought some **reading material** for the journey.

我帶了一些旅途中的**讀物**。

2. The course provides extra **reading material**.

這門課提供額外的**閱讀材料**。

Evidence / facts

10. material — facts or evidence relevant to a matter

= information or evidence used in investigation, law, research, etc.

資料；證據材料

Examples

1. The investigators reviewed all available **material**.

調查人員審閱了所有可取得的**資料**。

2. The court examined the relevant **material**.

法院審視了相關**證據材料**。

Creative content

11. material — content used by a performer/writer

= jokes, ideas, stories, songs, etc. used in a performance or creative work

表演素材；創作素材

Examples

1. The comedian is working on new **material**.

這位喜劇演員正在準備新的**表演素材**。

2. The writer drew **material** from personal experience.

作家從個人經歷中汲取**創作素材**。

Very useful media/creative sense.

Candidate / potential suitability

12. material — person suitable for a role

Usually in compounds:

= person considered suitable for a particular role or status

適合成為.....的人選

Examples

1. She is clearly management **material**.

她顯然是做管理層的**人才**。

2. He is not really leadership **material**.

他其實不太是做領導的**料**。

Informal but useful.

13. marriage material

= person considered suitable as a long-term marriage partner

適合結婚的對象

Examples

1. She joked that he was not **marriage material**.

她開玩笑說他不是適合結婚的**對象**。

2. The phrase **marriage material** is informal and highly context-dependent.

Marriage material 是非正式說法，而且很看語境。

Adjective: important / relevant

14. material — important to a decision or situation

Formal:

= important, relevant, or capable of affecting an outcome

****重要的；實質相關的；具關鍵影響的****

Examples

1. The new evidence is ****material**** to the case.

新證據對案件具有****實質重要性****。

2. There was no ****material difference**** between the two versions.

兩個版本之間沒有****實質差異****。

Major formal adjective sense.

15. material fact

= fact important enough to influence a decision, legal outcome, contract, etc.

****重大事實；重要事實****

Examples

1. The court considered whether the information was a ****material fact****.

法院考慮該資訊是否屬於****重大事實****。

2. A ****material fact**** should not be concealed.

****重大事實****不應被隱瞞。

16. material change

= significant change with real practical effect

****重大變化；實質變動****

Examples

1. There has been no ****material change**** in the situation.

情況沒有出現****重大變化****。

2. The agreement requires notice of any ****material changes****.

協議要求任何****重大變動****都須通知。

Adjective: physical / worldly

17. material — physical rather than spiritual or abstract

= relating to physical objects, possessions, or the physical world

****物質的；有形的****

Examples

1. People have both ****material and emotional needs****.

人既有****物質需求****，也有情感需求。

2. The philosophy rejects excessive concern with ****material possessions****.

這套哲學反對過度重視****物質財產****。

18. material possessions

= physical things a person owns

****物質財產；身外之物****

Examples

1. He cared little about ****material possessions****.

他不太重視****物質財產****。

2. Happiness cannot come only from ****material possessions****.

幸福不能只來自****物質上的擁有****。

Related forms

19. materially

A. significantly / importantly

****實質上；重大地****

1. The change did not ****materially**** affect the result.

這項改變並沒有**實質影響**結果。

B. in material/physical terms

在物質方面

2. They became **materially** better off.
他們在**物質生活上**變得更富裕。

20. materialize / materialise

A. appear / become real

出現；實現；成真

1. The opportunity never **materialized**.
那個機會最後沒有**出現 / 實現**。
2. Their plans finally **materialised**.
他們的計畫終於**實現了**。

B. literally appear in physical form

具體化；突然現身

3. The figure seemed to **materialize** out of nowhere.
那個身影彷彿突然從無處**現身**。

Important family extension.

21. materialization / materialisation

= process of becoming real, concrete, or physically present

實現；具體化；出現

Examples

1. The project was the **materialisation** of years of planning.
這個專案是多年規劃的**具體實現**。
2. The expected benefits did not lead to actual **materialization**.
預期的好處並未真正**實現**。

Materialism / materialistic

22. materialism

A. excessive importance placed on money and possessions

****物質主義；重物質****

1. The novel criticizes modern ****materialism****.

這本小說批評現代****物質主義****。

B. philosophy: reality is fundamentally material/physical

****唯物主義****

2. The course introduces philosophical ****materialism****.

這門課介紹哲學上的****唯物主義****。

Distinct specialist branch.

23. materialistic

= excessively concerned with money and possessions

****物質主義的；重物質的****

Examples

1. He dislikes a very ****materialistic**** lifestyle.

他不喜歡非常****重物質的生活方式****。

2. She is not particularly ****materialistic****.

她並不是特別****物質主義****的人。

High-value expressions

24. raw material — figurative

= basic information or experience from which something is created

****原始素材****

Examples

1. Personal experience became the **raw material** for her novel.
個人經歷成了她小說的**原始素材**。
2. Interviews provided **raw material** for the documentary.
訪問為紀錄片提供了**原始素材**。

25. material for something

= information, events, or qualities that could be used to create something
可作為.....的素材

Examples

1. The experience gave him **material** for a story.
那次經歷給了他寫故事的**素材**。
2. The incident provided plenty of **material** for discussion.
這件事提供了大量可供討論的**材料**。

26. management / leadership material

= person with qualities suitable for management or leadership
管理 / 領導人才

Examples

1. She looks like **management material**.
她看起來很有成為**管理人才**的潛質。
2. He proved to be excellent **leadership material**.
他證明自己很有成為**領導人才**的條件。

Key contrasts

27. material vs ingredient

ingredient

= component combined with others to make food, medicine, cosmetics, etc.

****食材；成分****

****material****

= broader substance or resource used to make something

****材料；物料****

Compare:

> cake ingredients

> 蛋糕食材

> packaging materials

> 包裝材料

In this passage, ****ingredients**** and ****materials**** are deliberately separate.

28. material vs substance

****substance****

= particular type of physical matter

****物質****

****material****

= matter viewed in terms of its practical use for making something

****材料****

Compare:

> a chemical substance

> 化學物質

> building material

> 建築材料

29. material vs fabric

****fabric****

= specifically cloth/textile

****布料****

****material****

= can mean fabric, but is much broader

Compare:

> cotton fabric

> 棉布

> construction material

> 建築材料

30. material vs content

****content****

= information or media contained in something

****內容****

****material****

= can mean source/content used for learning, writing, performance, etc.

****資料 ; 素材****

Compare:

> website content

> 網站內容

> teaching material

> 教材

31. material vs information

****information****

= facts or knowledge communicated

****資訊****

****material****

= information collected or prepared for a specific use

****資料 ; 素材****

32. material vs relevant

In formal contexts:

****relevant****

= connected with the issue

****相關的****

****material****

= relevant ****and important enough to affect the decision/outcome****

****具實質重要性的****

This distinction matters in legal/business English.

Meaning map

The central concrete concept of ****material**** is:

****substance from which something is made****

From this develop:

Passage

business materials

→ ****生產 / 營運物料****

Construction

building material

→ ****建築材料****

Clothing

material

→ ****布料****

Then abstractly:

Information

research material

→ ****研究資料****

Education

teaching material

→ **教材**

Creativity

comedy material

→ **表演素材**

Suitability

management material

→ **管理人才的料**

A separate adjective branch develops:

Importance

material fact

→ **重大事實**

Physical/worldly

material possessions

→ **物質財產**

And the family extends into:

materialize

→ **實現 / 出現**

materialism

→ **物質主義 / 唯物主義**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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material — physical substance	用來製造、建造或準備某物的材料 / 物料
raw material — physical	生產商品所需的基本原料
material — fabric	製作衣服、窗簾等使用的布料
material — information/content	為研究、寫作、創作等蒐集 / 使用的資料或素材

source material	創作、研究或改編所依據的原始資料 / 素材	
teaching/learning material	教學或學習使用的教材 / 學習材料	
reading material	供閱讀使用的文章、書籍等讀物	
material — evidence	調查、法律等使用的資料 / 證據材料	
material — creative content	作家、演員、喜劇演員等使用的創作 / 表演素材	
management/leadership material	具備成為管理者 / 領導者條件的人才	
material — important adjective	對結果、判斷或決定具有實質重要性的	
material fact	足以影響判斷或法律結果的重大事實	
material change	具有實際重要影響的重大變化	
material — physical/worldly adjective	與實體、金錢、財產等物質層面有關的	
material possessions	一個人擁有的有形物品 / 物質財產	
materially — significantly	在實質程度上、重大地	
materialize / materialise	原本只是可能或計畫的事情實際出現 / 實現	
materialization / materialisation	從想法、可能性變成現實的實現 / 具體化	
materialism — lifestyle/value	過度重視金錢與物質財產的物質主義	
materialism — philosophy	認為現實本質上以物質為基礎的唯物主義	
materialistic	過度重視金錢、財物和物質享受的	
raw material — figurative	可供創作、研究等加工使用的原始素材	
material for something	可用於創作、討論等的資料 / 素材	

Passage recap

> “...even a small business needs the right tools, ****materials****, and a bit of breathing room at the beginning.”

Here:

****materials**** = ****physical supplies or substances needed to produce and operate the business****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****材料****

* ****物料****

* ****所需用品****

Natural contextual translation:

****即使是小生意，起步時都需要合適的工具、材料，以及一點財務上的緩衝空間。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****material****

= ****a physical substance or supply used to make, build, or produce something****

****材料；物料****

The most important learner contrasts are:

> building ****material****

> → 建築材料

> dress ****material****

> → 布料

> teaching ****material****

> → 教材

> research ****material****

> → 研究資料

> comedy ****material****

> → 喜劇表演素材

> management ****material****

> → 有管理潛質的人

And the adjective changes direction again:

> ****material fact****

> → ****足以影響結果的重大事實****

> ****material possessions****

> → ****物質財產****

So ****material**** moves very productively from ****physical matter** → information/content → suitability → formal importance → material/physical life******.